

6. What to do, and when

Working backwards from an autumn 2027 start. Today is 17 August 2026, so you have about thirteen months.

Do these four things in the next two weeks

Everything else depends on them, and all four are free or cheap.

1. Read your diploma and answer two questions

Does it say *Licence Fondamentale* or *Licence Appliquée*? This decides whether the Netherlands is open or closed to you, and nothing else will tell you.

Do you hold the actual diploma, or only a transcript? This is the one scenario where your 146 credits would be a real problem rather than a bookkeeping artefact — because 180 credits come automatically with the awarded degree. We put this at about 5% likelihood, but it needs confirming, not assuming.

2. Book IELTS Academic — and know that it no longer blocks you

Earlier versions of this plan called the missing English test your single binding constraint. **That is no longer true**, and the correction matters for your timetable.

Three good programmes take you with no English certificate at all: EUBA Bratislava (free, AACSB, no test at any stage), Corvinus Budapest (triple-accredited, internal entrance exam), and Bergamo (B2 satisfied by 6 ECTS of English in your bachelor's). IHECS Brussels asks only B1, and BGE Budapest accepts IELTS 5.5.

So **you can apply for autumn 2027 while your score is still pending**. Book the test anyway — it opens far more doors for ~700 TND.

You can sit it **in Sousse**, for roughly 700 TND. Target **6.5**, which unlocks essentially everything on your shortlist at once. At 6.0 you still have options; at 5.5 you can reach the best Erasmus Mundus target (SDSI).

But there is no waiver at most institutions, and the one that looked promising doesn't work. FH Kufstein does accept medium-of-instruction letters — but only where the letter demonstrates "*CEFR level B2 or higher*", and a letter from a French/Arabic-medium faculty demonstrates the opposite. Kufstein needs **IELTS 6.0 / TOEFL 72 / PTE 60**, and explicitly rejects Duolingo.

3. Email FSEG Sousse

Ask the *scolarité* for two documents:

- A written **attestation on letterhead** stating your Licence comprises **180 credits over six semesters and three years**, and that it grants access to Mastère study in Tunisia.
- The **supplément au diplôme** (Diploma Supplement).

Both are free. Together they neutralise the "146" objection almost everywhere. The risk you actually face is an admissions officer rejecting your file on sight of that number before a qualified evaluator ever reads it — this is what prevents that.

4. Run the free credential checks

- **NARIC Ireland** — free comparability check. Do this before spending an Irish application, since Ireland is your genuine borderline case.
- **Denmark's assessment** — free, and legally **binding on Danish universities**.

Do **not** buy the French ENIC-NARIC evaluation yet (€120, and four to six months). Only order it if a specific programme demands it — and if you decide you need one, order by **late 2026**, because it cannot be rushed.

Your language strategy — commit to one, and only one

The brief was right to warn against spreading across several languages. Here is the recommendation.

For 2027: English only. Apply to Tier A programmes.

No new language reliably unlocks a 2027 intake. Starting Spanish part-time in September 2026 gets you a certified B2 somewhere between November 2027 and January 2028 — after the intake has begun. Only a full-time 25-hour-a-week course would reach B2 by March 2027, and that means giving up a year of earning to chase a saving you can get elsewhere.

So: run the 2027 cycle on **English and French programmes only**. That is where your shortlist already lives.

If you commit to a language, make it Spanish — for 2028

Spanish and Italian are equally fast for a French speaker (roughly 13–15 months part-time, 4.5–5.5 full-time). **Spanish wins on three tiebreakers:**

1. **Job-market reach** — Spain plus Latin America, versus Italy alone.
2. **Your music interest** — Madrid and Barcelona are the European hub of the Latin music market, which is the fastest-growing segment of the global industry.
3. **Logistics** — you can sit the **DELE B2 in Tunis** for 260 TND, with a published 2026 calendar. The Italian institute's page still shows 2024 dates and no fees.

Do not learn German, Czech, Polish or a Nordic language. German takes 22–28 months part-time — and you do not need it: the three open German programmes (HWR Berlin, KU Eichstätt, HM München) are **English-taught**. Czech and Polish take three years or more. The economics never work.

One honest caveat: if you end up at Bologna (GIOCA), Italian becomes the more useful language and you should switch. Decide after your admissions results, not before.

The timeline

Now – September 2026

- Read your diploma; confirm you hold it
- Book and schedule IELTS
- Request the FSEG attestation and *supplément au diplôme*
- **Register for the SAT if Slovakia interests you.** Slovakia's €10,000 scholarship ranks foreign applicants on the **SAT result alone** — your GPA is never consulted and no English certificate is required. Minimum 1100. It is the only scholarship found in Europe that screens on something you can go and change.
- **Budget for the visa resource requirement, not just tuition** — France now needs ~€14,500 demonstrated for year one, Norway ~€14,600, Finland €9,600. This is the real barrier, and it needs planning months ahead
- Run NARIC Ireland's free check
- Start Spanish **only if you're targeting 2028**
- Publish your CRM project properly (see below)

Urgent — before December 2026

- **1 December 2026: INN Norway deadline** — the earliest hard date found anywhere (though see the Norway funds warning in deliverable 4)
- **Early November 2026: file Denmark's free credential assessment** — it takes 1–2 months and Aalborg's **non-EU deadline is 15 January**, not the 1 March date published for EU applicants

October 2026

- **~Oct: Tunisian MESRS circular.** The **grant** is closed to you — verified against Circulaire 61/25, which offers 10 EU places in STEM fields only, caps age at 24, and requires current enrolment in year 3. Ask FSEG about the **loan** version only
- **~1 Oct: Campus France Études en France opens.** Mandatory for French applications. Fee 400 TND. Book the interview early — it can be done in Sousse
- **~1 Oct: Eiffel campaign opens.** You cannot apply yourself — **ask each French university's international office, in writing, whether they will nominate you**, and ask before their internal selection closes
- Erasmus Mundus 2027 applications begin opening
- Sit IELTS if not already done

November – December 2026

- **Stipendium Hungaricum call opens (~Nov)** — Tunisia holds a 250-place quota
- Erasmus Mundus applications: **SDSI first**, then others
- Order the French credential evaluation **only if** a target programme requires it — it takes 4–6 months
- Draft your motivation letters (see the framing advice below)

January – March 2027

- **~8 Jan: Eiffel deposit deadline** — your university must have filed by now
- **~15 Jan: Stipendium Hungaricum closes**, 14:00 CET
- **~15 Jan: Campus France closes.** Earlier than the universities' own deadlines. Missing it removes France entirely
- **Jan–Feb:** most Erasmus Mundus deadlines close
- **Feb: CLIDE opens** — the latest EMJM window, useful if your IELTS came late
- **3 Mar: FH Kufstein deadline** — your cheapest and most open option. Do not miss this one
- **~26 Mar: MAECI (Italy)** — needs a B2 certificate

Spring – Summer 2027

- University decisions arrive
- **~May: NAWA Banach (Poland)** — Tunisia is explicitly eligible, no field restriction
- Apply for individual fee exemption in France on means grounds, if admitted
- **Jun–Aug: ER-GO grant window** (23 Jun – 24 Aug) if you're going to Bologna
- **~Jul: AECID África-Med (Spain)** — verify the public-employee restriction first
- Start the visa process. Budget for proof-of-funds requirements — these are large and catch people out
- Arrange the *ISEE parificato* if Italy

On arrival, autumn 2027

- **Italy: file the ISEE by ~30 October**, or you pay a €100 penalty and land in the top fee band
- **Spain: file proof of your student authorisation before 1 November**, or you can be billed up to the full real cost of the course

Your profile — honestly assessed

What's genuinely strong

The CRM platform. It is the best thing you have, by a distance. You designed and built a working system for customer retention, vehicle tracking and automated service reminders. That is a real technical artefact, and almost no marketing applicant has one.

It also happens to be *exactly* what the most sponsorable jobs are looking for — and it is literally service design, which is why SDSI is your best Erasmus Mundus target.

Native French. This is worth more than it appears. Marketing is a language-heavy profession; in France, Belgium or Luxembourg you can work in the local language from day one, while in Ireland or the Netherlands you'd compete against native English speakers for English-language roles.

What's weak, stated plainly

- **No English test.** Fixable in weeks. It is currently your single binding constraint.
- **12–13/20 GPA.** Modest. It closes Germany, makes ULiège marginal, and probably rules out MAGMa. It does *not* close Austria, Poland, Italy or Ireland, because those select on subject tests and interviews rather than GPA ranking. Choose accordingly.
- **No European work experience.** The most important thing your master's can fix.
- **No music portfolio.** You are a self-taught hobbyist producer. Do not overstate this in applications — programmes that require a portfolio will see through it, and you don't need to compete on that ground.

The five things to do in the next 6–12 months

In order of return:

1. **Choose your programme partly on whether it includes a European internship or *alternance*.** This is worth more than everything else on this list combined. Graduating with a European internship on your CV is what converts a degree into a job offer, and a job offer into a visa.
2. **Publish the CRM project as a documented GitHub repository.** Screenshots, architecture notes, the problem it solved, the results. Right now it's a line on a transcript; it should be a link you can put in every application and every job interview.
3. **Learn SQL and Python,** plus GA4, one customer-data platform, and one BI tool (Power BI or Tableau). These are the specific skills that move you from "marketing graduate" to "marketing data analyst".
4. **Sit IELTS.**
5. **Start Spanish** — but only if you're targeting 2028.

The strategic point that matters most

Immigration systems across Europe have independently converged on the same rule: they keep the door open for technical roles and close it for non-technical junior white-collar ones. Look at the UK's own occupational medians against its £41,700 permit threshold:

Role	Median pay	Clears the bar?
Advertising/marketing associate	£33,400	No
Arts officer/producer	£38,100	No
Musician	£37,500	No
IT business analyst	£54,900	Yes
Programmer	£54,700	Yes

France draws the same line at 1.5x the minimum wage — about €33,600/year. A junior CRM or data role in Paris clears it. A junior label or promotions role does not. *(This threshold is from secondary sources — the official pages were unreachable — so confirm it before relying on the exact figure.)*

The practical consequence is almost absurdly specific: the job title on your contract decides whether you can stay.

"Marketing Executive" — loses. "Marketing Data Analyst" — wins. Same work. Same company. Different outcome.

So: **lean technical.** Choose programmes with a data component. Take the analytics electives. Build the GitHub portfolio. Your CRM project makes this a realistic repositioning rather than an aspirational one — you have already done the thing, you just need the credential and the vocabulary to match.

And treat music as a sector, not a job description. The sponsorable door into the music industry is a data or CRM requisition at Spotify, Deezer, Believe or Universal — not an artist-management role at a four-person label. Bologna's GIOCA is on your shortlist precisely because it lets you study the culture industry without giving up a management-track qualification.

What we couldn't finish

Five research streams were cut short when the session hit a hard capacity limit. In fairness to you, the gaps that could change your decisions:

- **Nobody swept Austria properly.** FH Kufstein — your top recommendation — was found incidentally by a researcher working on something else. There are likely other Austrian applied-sciences programmes just as good, and **this is the first gap worth closing.**
- **France's IAE network is under-sampled** — six of about thirty. France is your best-fit country.
- **Scholarships are now researched and verified.** Two findings belong here: **Austria, your top-ranked destination, has no national scholarship open to you** (Ernst Mach does not fund full FH degrees; Erhard Busek is suspended), so cost it as fully self-funded — survivable at €727/year, but do not budget on aid appearing. And **the Tunisian government grant we initially recommended is closed to you** — see deliverable 5.
- **Cost-of-living figures now exist** for French cities. Rennes is cheapest at €1,192/month, Paris dearest at €1,627 — a €4,800/year gap, more than a year's tuition. Montpellier has free public transport.
- **No cost-of-living figures anywhere.** Every researcher declined to estimate rather than publish unsourced numbers. You'll need these to budget, and they're easy to find yourself.
- **The Nordics were never swept** — though on cost they were unlikely to survive anyway.
- **Most 2027/28 deadlines are unpublished.** Dates here are largely the 2026/27 cycle, used as an indication. **Re-check every deadline before you rely on it.**